



37.7833° S / 144.7667° E
DERRIMUT · MELBOURNE

PRICING CALCULATOR

proposal & FORMULA

The exact logic behind Meridian's live "Instant Quote" calculator — what the customer enters, how each cost is worked out, and how it compares to the market.

PREPARED FOR

Meridian 3PL

DOCUMENT

Pricing Formula v1.0

STATUS

Draft for approval

BENCHMARK

vs NPFulfilment

Purpose. This calculator lets a prospect enter a few details about their operation and instantly see an estimated cost — shown both **per order** and **per month** — before they ever speak to sales. It is built on four principles: **transparency** (real published rates, not “contact us for a quote”), **two views** (sellers think per-order, owners think monthly), **starter-friendly** (it works for small clients that larger competitors’ tools ignore), and an **honest estimate** that a short conversation then confirms.

Conventions. All prices are in **AUD** and **exclude GST**. Every tiered rate uses the **whole-quantity rule**: the entire quantity is charged at the rate of the band it lands in (e.g. 18 pallets are all charged at the 11–25 rate — not split across bands).

01 WHAT THE CUSTOMER *enters*

FIELD	RANGE / FORMAT	USED FOR
Average orders per month	1 – 5,000+	Pick & pack, per-order maths
Average items per order	1.0 – 10.0	Additional-item picking
Pallets stored	0 – 55 (then custom)	Storage
Pallets received / month	0 – 50	Inbound receiving
Unique SKUs	1 – 1,000	One-off SKU setup (optional)
Average order weight (kg)	0.1 – 22	Shipping band
Extra services (optional)	returns, relabel, kitting, urgent	Add-ons

A Monthly Account Fee — covers admin, software access, account management and support.

STARTER · UNDER 1,000
ORDERS / MO

\$299

per month

GROWTH · 1,000–3,000
ORDERS / MO

\$499

per month

CUSTOM · 3,000+ ORDERS OR
55+ PALLETS

Quoted

tailored

B Storage — per pallet position, per month.

Storage = Pallets Stored × Monthly Rate (whole-quantity band)

PALLETS STORED	RATE / PALLET / MONTH
1–10	\$40
11–25	\$35
26–55	\$30
56+	Custom (beyond current facility capacity)

Example: 12 pallets → 12 × \$35 = \$420 / month.

C Inbound Receiving — per pallet received that month.

Receiving = Pallets Received × Rate (whole-quantity band)

PALLETS RECEIVED / MONTH	RATE / PALLET
1–10	\$22
11–30	\$18
31+	\$15

Optional one-off SKU setup (new clients, billed once at onboarding): SKU Setup = Unique SKUs × \$2.20 — e.g. 60 SKUs = \$132 (one-time, shown separately from the monthly total).

D Pick & Pack — the main revenue driver.

Pick & Pack = Orders × First-Item Fee
+ (Orders × (Items per Order – 1)) × Additional-Item Fee

CHARGE	RATE
First item in each order	\$3.50
Each additional item	\$0.50

Example: 600 orders at 1.8 items → (600 × \$3.50) + (600 × 0.8 × \$0.50) = \$2,340.

E Shipping — weight-banded, with handling margin (≈15%) already included.

Shipping = Orders × Band Price (selected by average order weight)

AVERAGE ORDER WEIGHT	PRICE / ORDER	WEIGHT	PRICE / ORDER
up to 0.5 kg	\$8.50	3–5 kg	\$14.50
0.5–1 kg	\$10.50	5–10 kg	\$18.50
1–2 kg	\$11.50	10–15 kg	\$24.00
2–3 kg	\$12.50	15–22 kg	\$30.00

These band prices are placeholders based on typical Australian domestic parcel pricing. Final bands will be set from Meridian's actual courier rate card (Australia Post / Aramex / Couriers Please). Once confirmed, the real numbers are plugged straight in.

F Extras — optional add-ons.

SERVICE	RATE	SERVICE	RATE
Returns processing	\$7.00 each	Urgent same-day dispatch	\$50.00 each
Relabelling	\$1.00 / unit	Kitting / assembly	\$0.80 / unit
Custom packaging	Quoted		

03 THE *totals* & A WORKED EXAMPLE

MONTHLY TOTAL =

- Account Fee
- + Storage
- + Receiving
- + Pick & Pack
- + Shipping
- + Extras

COST PER ORDER =

Monthly Total ÷ Orders per Month

(we also show a fulfilment-only per-order figure – everything except shipping – the number sellers compare between 3PLs)

Worked example. 600 orders/month · 1.8 items/order · 12 pallets stored · 8 pallets received/month · 60 SKUs · 1.2 kg average weight · 30 returns/month.

COMPONENT	CALCULATION	MONTHLY	PER ORDER
Account fee (Starter)	flat	\$299	\$0.50
Storage	12 × \$35	\$420	\$0.70
Receiving	8 × \$22	\$176	\$0.29
Pick & pack	2,100 + 240	\$2,340	\$3.90
Extras	30 × \$7	\$210	\$0.35
Fulfilment subtotal	ex-shipping	\$3,445	\$5.74
Shipping	600 × \$11.50	\$6,900	\$11.50
ALL-IN TOTAL		\$10,345 / mo	\$17.24 / order

Plus one-off SKU setup: 60 × \$2.20 = \$132 at onboarding.

04 HOW THIS COMPARES TO *NPFulfilment*

NPFulfilment is one of Australia’s largest 3PLs and runs a well-known online pricing tool, so it’s a useful benchmark. The two approaches are built on opposite philosophies — and where their numbers are strong, Meridian’s model already adopts them.

DIMENSION	NPFULFILMENT	MERIDIAN (PROPOSED)	VERDICT
Pick & pack, 1st item	\$3.30	\$3.50	Near-identical — rates are market-real
Each additional item	\$0.40	\$0.50	In line with market
Storage / pallet / mo	~\$5.35 (teaser)	\$30–40	Meridian honest; theirs understated
Inbound receiving	\$10/pallet + \$2.20/SKU	\$15–22/pallet (+opt. \$2.20/SKU)	Adopted their per-SKU idea
Shipping	9-band weight table	8-band weight table	Adopted — solves live shipping
Account / base fee	None shown	\$299–499/mo	Meridian keeps a revenue floor
Result framing	Per order only	Per order + monthly	Meridian shows both
Minimum volume	500 orders/mo floor	No floor	Meridian serves small clients
Quote visibility	Gated behind a lead form	Instant, on-page	Meridian more transparent
Technology	3rd-party embed (Calconic)	Native – Meridian owns the data	Faster, on-brand, owns leads

WHAT MERIDIAN BORROWS FROM THEM

- **Weight-banded postage table** — their best idea. It lets a live shipping price appear instantly without a courier API.
- **Per-SKU receipt fee** — a real revenue line the original Meridian model didn’t capture.

WHERE MERIDIAN IS DELIBERATELY DIFFERENT

- **Radical transparency** — the price is on-screen, not gated behind a form.
- **Serves smaller clients** — no 500-order floor; ideal for first-time sellers.
- **Honest storage & a base fee** — sustainable economics, not a teaser headline.

THE BOTTOM LINE

MORE TRANSPARENT THAN THE INCUMBENT, AND BUILT FOR THE CLIENTS THEY *turn away*.

Meridian’s rates are validated against the market leader to within cents, adopt their two strongest mechanics, and add a live monthly total they don’t offer — all in a fast, on-brand tool that delivers every enquiry to Meridian’s inbox or a dedicated admin dashboard on the website.

05 ITEMS FOR *sign-off*

- 01 **Account fee tiers** — Starter \$299 / Growth \$499 / Custom. Approve or adjust?
- 02 **Storage** — keep honest rates \$40 / \$35 / \$30 per pallet (recommended), or run a lower “teaser” headline?
- 03 **Inbound receiving** — per-pallet \$22 / \$18 / \$15 confirmed?
- 04 **SKU setup fee** — include the optional one-off \$2.20 / SKU onboarding charge? Yes / No.
- 05 **Pick & pack** — \$3.50 first item + \$0.50 each additional confirmed?
- 06 **Shipping bands** — approve the structure, and send Meridian’s real **courier rate card** to replace the placeholders.
- 07 **Extras** — returns \$7 · relabel \$1 · kitting \$0.80 · urgent \$50 · custom = quote.
- 08 **Capacity rule** — over 55 pallets the calculator shows “Contact us for custom pricing.” OK?

Once approved — and ideally with the courier rate card in hand — this logic is implemented directly into the website’s Get-a-Quote calculator: live per-order and monthly totals, with every enquiry delivered straight to Meridian’s inbox — or into a dedicated admin dashboard on the website, where the team can review, track, and action each quote in one place.

